

points and the two associated controversies to be examined in Section B, are clearly delimited underneath in the unit content section of the specification. Collectively, they offer a framework for understanding this period as a whole.

Although the bullet points are defined and clarified separately here, students should appreciate the links between them, since questions may be set which target the content of more than one bullet point. For example, students might draw on elements of each of the first three bullet points in an explanation of the pressures for parliamentary reform in the period 1760-1800.

The first bullet point relates to the revival of reform, c1760-85. Questions will not be set on the period prior to 1760 but students should understand the nature of government and authority at the beginning of the period. Questions will not be set which focus exclusively on the origins or the course of the American Revolution but students should have contextual awareness of how the American issue generated hostility to the existing regime and encouraged calls for reform. In explaining the revival of reform and its significance to 1785, students should have knowledge and understanding of the roles and importance of individuals and movements: Edmund Burke, John Wilkes and Christopher Wyvill, the County Association Movement, and the pressure for 'economical reform'. The phrase 'economical reform' relates to proposals to reduce what its advocates considered to be the waste, and associated corruption, attending the provision of various government posts, many of which were sinecures.

The second bullet requires a study of the impact of the French revolution on political thought and on pressure for reform in Britain. The phrase 'the significance of Thomas Paine' relates to Paine's work and influence in Britain after 1789. Questions will not be set on his career before that date or on time spent in France or the United States, which did not relate to his impact on events in Britain. Students should have knowledge and understanding of Whig Association of the Friends of the People and of the corresponding societies active in the 1780s. They should also have knowledge and understanding of the careers and influence of John Cartwright, Thomas Hardy and J Horne Tooke.

The third bullet point relates to Government responses to growing radicalism in the period c1780-1815. Students should have knowledge of: the Public Meetings Act of 1795, the Seditious Practices Act 1795 and the Combination Acts of 1799 and 1800. In addition there needs to be some consideration of how the Government exploited conservative opinion through the Association for the Preservation of Liberty and Property in 1792. Students should also be aware of the influence of Edmund Burke's Reflections on the Revolution in France as a response to popular radicalism. The phrase 'the impact of the Evangelical revival' in the specification relates to those aspects of Evangelicalism which contested the ideas and attitudes of radical politicians and pressure groups. In this context, students should have knowledge and understanding of the work of William Wilberforce and of Hannah More, whose conservative political influence in the Cheap Repository Tracts was an aspect of 'moral reform', and the Sunday School movement. Questions will not be set, however, which focus exclusively on religion or on the anti-slavery campaigns.

The fourth bullet point requires a study of conservatism and reform in the period 1812-30. Students need to consider the impact of 'Liberal Toryism' as a means of providing reforms which aimed at correcting abuses in the present system, of stimulating job-creating economic expansion and at undermining the economic basis for radical politics. They should have knowledge of the roles of key individuals: Lord Liverpool, Huskisson and Robinson in commerce and Peel at the Home Office. In terms of 'changing attitudes', students should be able to consider the extent to which Liberal Toryism' represented a departure from the earlier period of conservative government. They should have appreciate the significance of Daniel O'Connell and the Catholic Association in pressing for reform and of the passage of the Roman Catholic Relief Act in 1829, but detailed knowledge of events in Ireland is not required. They should also have knowledge of Whig attitudes to reform and of the extent to which pressure for reform outside Parliament increased during the 1820s.

In Section B, students will use their knowledge of the period as a whole to provide broad contextual knowledge but, in addition, they will need detailed knowledge of the two issues selected as subjects of historical controversy and an understanding of why this area has been the subject of debate.

The first controversy relates to the popular and political reform protests and conspiracies in the period 1815-30 and the extent of the threat that they posed to the established governments of Lord Liverpool, Canning, Goderich and Wellington. Students should be aware of the historical debate which surrounds this issue.

The second controversy requires a study of the impact of the industrial revolution in terms of social and economic change in the period c1780-1830. Some historians have argued that the industrial revolution did immense damage to the lives and opportunities of the labouring classes; others have argued that it opened them up as a result of educational opportunities, improved standards of living and greater economic security.

Unit 3, Option C: The United States: Challenged and Transformed

Topic C1: The United States, 1820-77: A Disunited Nation?

The focus of this topic is on the extent to which the union was threatened either by conflicts over civil rights and slavery or by the differential impact of economic growth which occurred in the period 1820–77 and on how these conflicts were resolved in the United States. The key areas of study required for section A are summarised in the four bullet points and the associated controversies, to be examined in section B are clearly delimited underneath the unit content section of the specification. Collectively, they offer a framework of study for the period 1820-77.

Although the bullet points are defined and clarified separately here, students should appreciate the links between them, since questions may be set which target the content of more than one bullet point. For example, students might draw on elements within each of the first and fourth bullet points in an explanation of the reasons for the failure to extend civil rights to African-Americans in this period.

The first bullet point will address the period 1820–57. Although questions will not be set specifically on the period before 1820, the legacy of the slave trade and attempts to make it illegal in the US in 1808 and the crises that emerged will be a necessary part of the study. Knowledge and understanding of the Missouri Compromise and of its significance in hardening attitudes towards slavery is essential. Students should also have knowledge of the Compromise of 1850, the Kansas-Nebraska Act of 1854 and the Dred Scott case, and of their significance for the growing political conflict over slavery and states rights.

The second bullet point will address the economy of the US in the period 1820-77 and the differences between north and south and east and west. Students should be aware of the key differences in the economies and forms of wealth creation of the southern and northern states in these years. Students should be aware of the growth in population in the US, the impact of westward expansion for the economy in this period and the expansion of urbanisation and industrialisation, particularly in the north.